DIGITAL SKILLS FOR ENTREPRENEURS (DSE) TRAINING IMPLEMENTATION REPORT - COHORT 1

Implementation Location: **Ogun State & Lagos State** | Program Duration: **October 17 – November 7, 2025**

Implemented by: Digiplus ALLIANCE

Supported by: german cooperation DEUTSCHE ZUSAMMENARBEIT; Co-funded by the European Union; Implemented by giz Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH; NITDA National Information Technology Development Agency; DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION CENTER NIGERIA

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List of Abbreviations

Acronym	Meaning
BMC	Business Model Canvas
CRM	Customer Relationship Management
DSE	Digital Skills for Entrepreneurs
DTC Nigeria	Digital Transformation Center Nigeria
DTR	Digital Transformation Roadmap
FMCG	Fast Moving Consumer Goods
GIZ	Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit
MSME	Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprise
SEO	Search Engine Optimization
SME	Small and Medium-sized Enterprises

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Executive Summary

The Digital Skills for Entrepreneurs (DSE) Program successfully trained 89 MSMEs across 2 states (Ogun State – 35, Lagos State – 54) through a combination of physical workshops and virtual sessions held from October 17 to November 7, 2025. The program focused on digital competence, digital marketing, innovation, e-commerce, financial literacy, content creation, and the development of Digital Transformation Roadmaps (DTRs).

A total of 207 participants were registered for the program, with women representing 62% of the cohort, and 2% identified as persons living with disability. The application pool was predominantly from Lagos state, accounting for 68% of submissions which influenced the proportional selection of participants across both states. Participants came from a wide range of industries with the highest representation from the food services sector, followed by the Fast Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG).

Participants demonstrated strong engagement during both physical and virtual sessions, with the program achieving an impressive 82% attendance and participation rate. Feedback from the post-assessment revealed that 95% rated the training as either excellent or good, with 76% strongly affirming facilitators' mastery of the subject matter. By the end of the program, a significant number of participants completed their DTRs, reflecting a strong grasp of the skills taught. Moreover, many participants reported measurable improvements in key areas such as business operations, marketing visibility, and digital adoption practices.

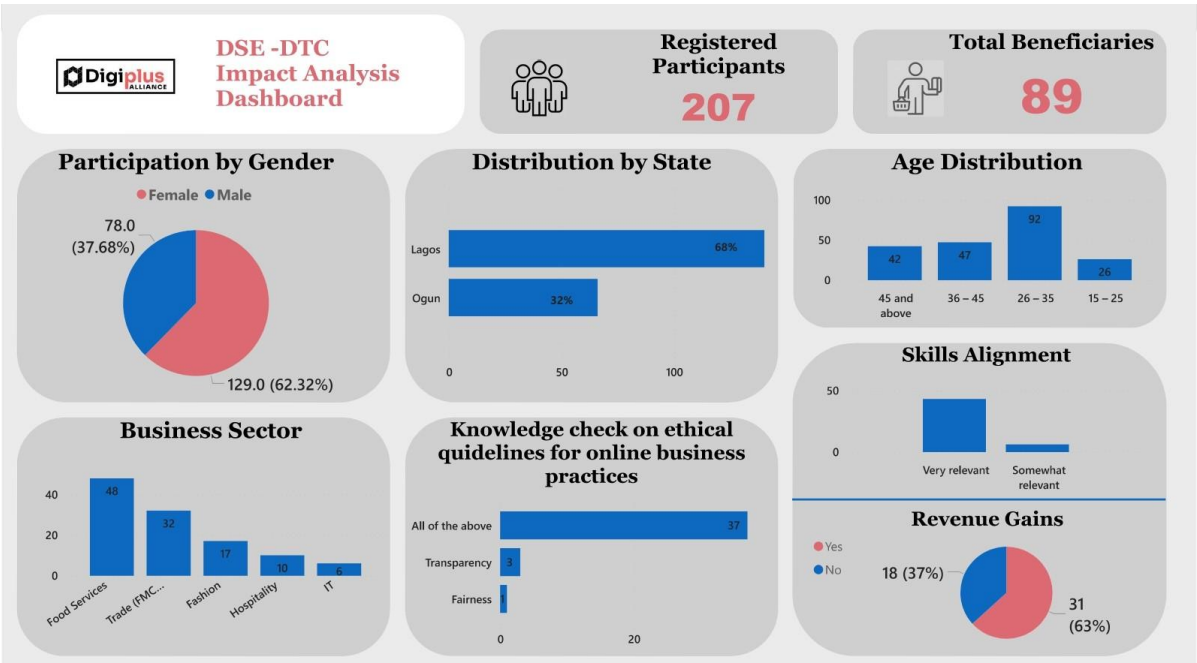


Figure 1 - DSE-DTC Impact Analysis Dashboard

1.0 Introduction

The DSE program is closely aligned with the core mandate of the Digital Transformation Center (DTC) Nigeria; accelerate digital adoption among entrepreneurs and strengthen SME capacity for digital growth. Delivered by Digiplus Alliance as the implementing partner, the program provided a blended learning experience designed to equip entrepreneurs with practical digital competencies. This approach ensured participants were well-positioned to navigate and thrive in Nigeria's rapidly evolving digital economy.

The program emphasised:

- Digital transformation readiness
- Digital marketing
- E-commerce enablement
- Productivity tools
- Innovation and entrepreneurial mindset
- Business management and project planning

Figure 2 - A group photograph of Ogun participants of the GIZ/DTC DSE Training

2.0 Program Overview

The physical workshops introduced participants to all 15 DSE thematic topics, including Digital Marketing, Innovation, Financial Management, Digital Competence, Online Presence, and Business Growth Strategies.

2.1 Ogun State Cohort

- **Dates:** October 17 – November 6, 2025
- **Participants:** 35
- **Location:** Food Mama Restaurant, Magboro
- **Format:**
  - 3-day physical foundational workshop
  - 10-day joint virtual sessions
  - One additional physical review session on November 6 (DTR review & certification prep)
  - The last physical day being the graduation ceremony.

2.2 Lagos State Cohort

- **Dates:** October 18 – November 7, 2025
- **Participants**: 50
- **Location:** 8thGear Hub, Magodo
- **Format:**
  - 3-day physical foundational workshop
  - 10 days joint virtual sessions with Ogun cohort
  - Final physical review session on November 7 (DTR finalization & graduation prep)
  - The last physical day being the graduation ceremony.

3.0 Training Implementation

The training followed a hybrid delivery structure, combining both in-person workshops and virtual instructor-led sessions to ensure flexibility, accessibility, and optimal learning outcomes for participants across Ogun and Lagos States. The physical sessions were intentionally scheduled at the start of the program to introduce all 15 course modules, engage participants in foundational exercises, and prepare them for deeper exploration during the virtual phase. This was followed by a series of structured online classes delivered twice daily; morning and evening, allowing participants to apply digital tools in real time while accommodating their business schedules. Each delivery mode served a distinct purpose and collectively ensured comprehensive, practical, and inclusive learning.

3.1 Physical Training Implementation

Participants completed an intensive 3-day in-person training covering all key modules at a glance. Activities included:

- Opening formalities & pre-assessments
- Introduction to the Digital Transformation Roadmap (DTR)
- Overview of topics 1–15
- Group discussions and hands-on digital tool exercises
- Networking and peer learning
- Daily assessments

3.1.1 Ogun State (October 17–21, 2025)

The additional physical session on November 6 provided a final walkthrough of the DTR and prepared participants for certification.

3.1.2 Lagos State (October 18–23, 2025)

Similarly, Lagos participants completed a 3-day workshop including: Their closing physical session held on November 7 focused on refining their DTRs ahead of the graduation ceremony.

3.2 Virtual Training Implementation

The Virtual sessions were conducted from October 24 to November 3, strategically scheduled twice daily; morning slot (11am–1pm) and evening slot (8pm–10pm) to accommodate diverse participants' availability.\

Key features:

- Live demonstrations
- Practical tool walkthroughs
- Polls, quizzes, and interactive assignments
- Peer reviews

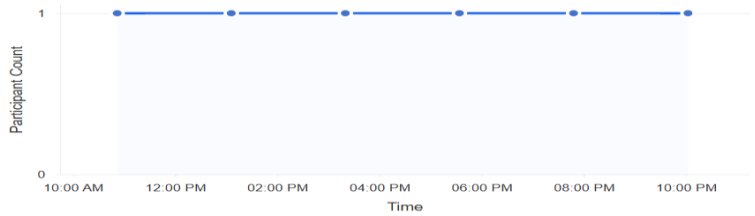
- Facilitator-led Q&A
- Technical support team availability

Despite occasional network disruptions reported by participants, overall engagement remained high, with 74% attendance at least one session daily.
Below are screenshots of the analytics from the virtual classes held on Zoho Meeting:

Participant Engagement Report

Digital Skills for Entrepreneurs

Oct 29, 2025 11:00 AM WAT - 12 hours 8thGear Hub



Participant	Role	Device	In and Out Time	Duration	IP Address
Elvis Ogbeide Ojekhebho	Participant	Android	10:51 AM - 11:25 AM	33 minutes	105.113.10

Figure 3 - Participant Engagement Report

articipant	Role	Device	In and Out Time	Duration
Elvis Ogbeide Ojekhebho	Participant	Android	10:51 AM - 11:25 AM	33 minutes
damilola@8thgearpartners.com	Host	Web browser	10:53 AM - 09:15 PM	10 hours 21 minutes
Shonde Olubukola Favour	Participant	Android	10:55 AM - 12:02 PM	1 hour 6 minutes
Yunusa	Participant	Android	10:58 AM - 12:09 PM	1 hour 11 minutes
Joseph Oluwatimileyin	Participant	Android	10:59 AM - 12:04 PM	1 hour 5 minutes

Figure 4 - Virtual Engagement Analysis

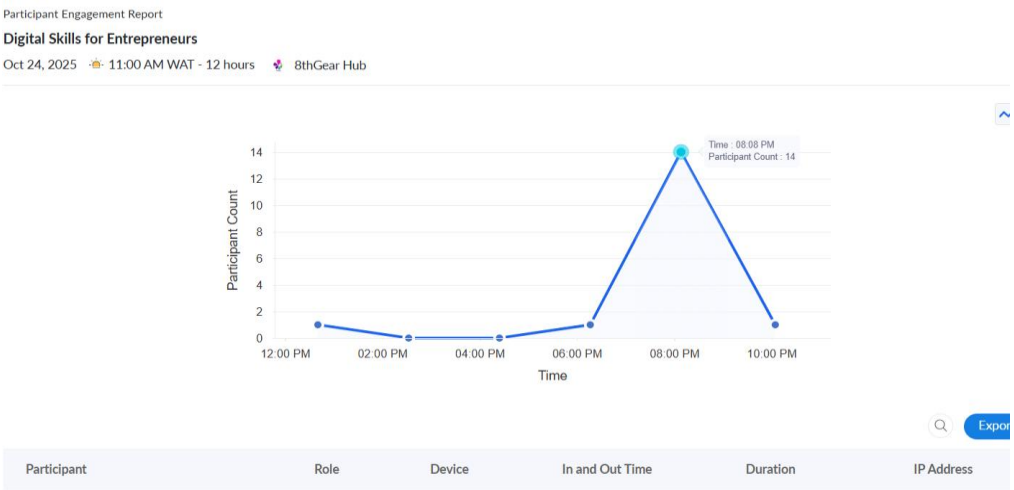


Figure 5 - Poll Response Analytics

4.0 Facilitators & Tools Delivered

Below is the full list of online topics (as provided):

1. Live Polls / Survey Tools Tools: Slido, Kahoot, Google Forms Date: October 24	**2. Social Media Management** Platforms: Facebook, Instagram, TikTok Date: October 25	**3. Business & Productivity Suite (Zoho)** Tools: Zoho Invoice, Books, CRM, Sales IQ, Campaigns Dates: October 27 & 28
4. Telecom Marketing Solutions Tools: MTN Target Messaging, Corporate Ringback Tunes Date: October 29	**5. Digital Marketing Tools** Tools: SEO, Meta Ads Date: October 30	**6. Content Creation & Design** Tools: Capcut, Canva, Inshot Dates: October 31 & November 1

7. Project Management Tools Tools: Trello, Asana, WhatsApp Business, URI, ChatGPT for Business Date: November 3	**Tools Demonstrated Across Sessions** Canva Google Workspace Meta Business Suite	Google Business Profile Flutterwave Store Shopify CRM systems AI-assisted tools

5.0 Outcomes

Data extracted from participant feedback forms reflects significant program success: To assess the effectiveness and impact of the program, a structured post-training survey was deployed to all participants. The survey aimed to capture feedback on participation, knowledge gains, and business impact. It was administered via Google Forms immediately following the completion of the training sessions, ensuring timely and relevant responses. Participants were encouraged to provide honest and detailed feedback on their experiences, the usefulness of the training content, and any observable changes in their business operations or skills. The data collected provides a comprehensive insight into program outcomes and participant satisfaction.

5.1 Participation & Completion

- 89 participants trained across both states
- Above average completed Digital Transformation Roadmaps
- 74% attendance and participation rate
- Strong engagement in both morning and evening virtual classes

5.2 Knowledge Gains

Participants reported substantial improvement in:

- Digital marketing confidence (7–10/10)
- Financial management skills
- Project management
- Effective use of productivity tools
- Content creation
- E-commerce adoption

5.3 Business Impact

From feedback responses:

- Revenue increases reported: 5%, 10%, up to 50%
- Increased frequency of online marketing
- Adoption of new payment and sales platforms
- Stronger customer engagement via WhatsApp Business & CRM tools
- Improved recordkeeping using Zoho Books
- Faster business processes and better coordination

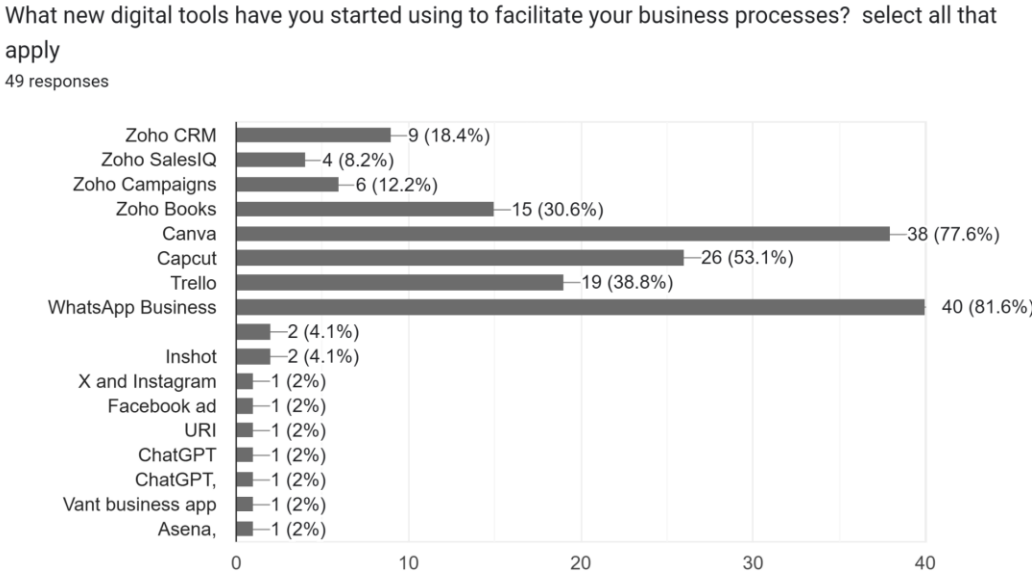


Figure 6 - New digital tools adopted

Figure 7 - Sector - specific digital tools

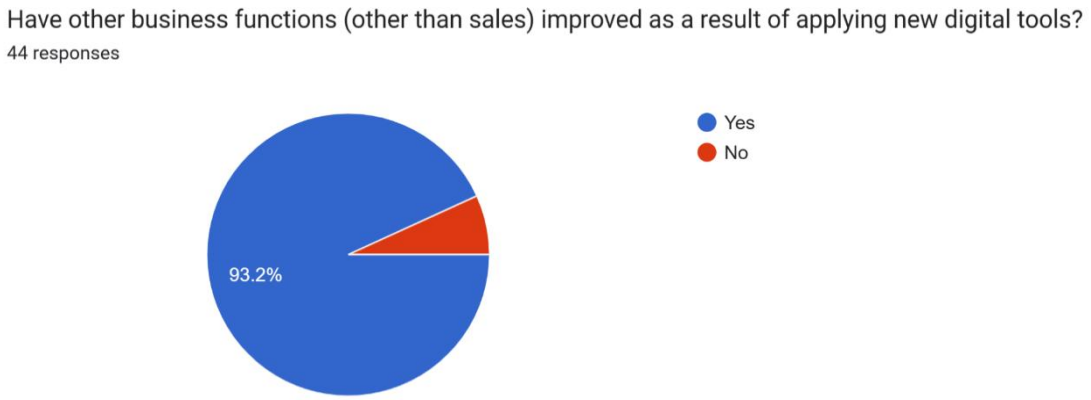


Figure 8 - Business functions applying new digital tools

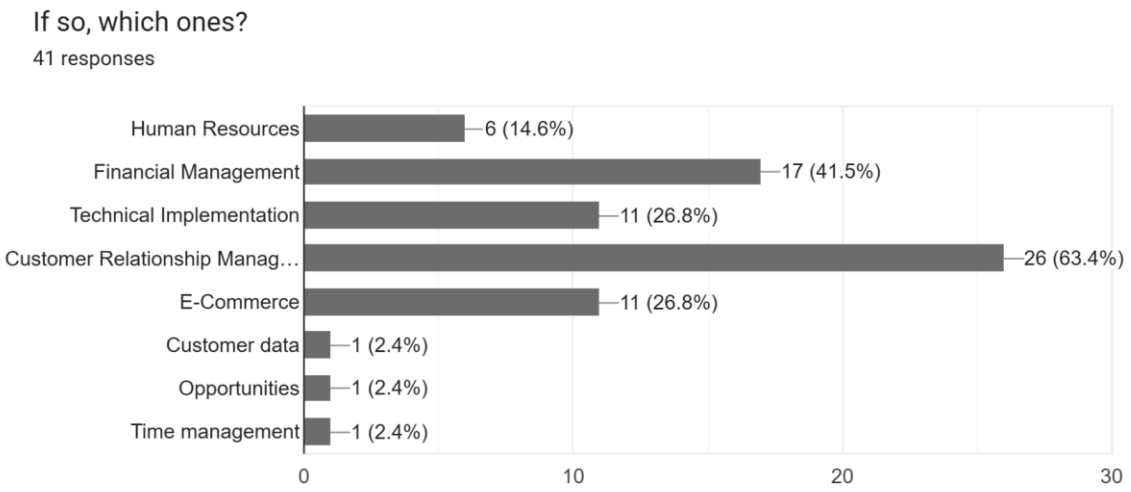


Figure 9 - Business Sectors

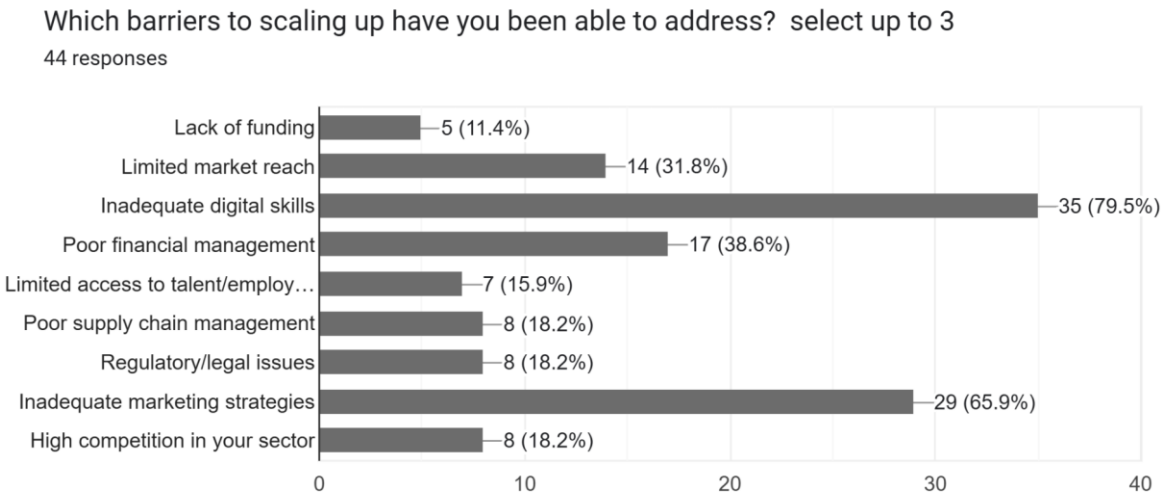


Figure 10 - Barriers to scaling up

5.4 Employment Impact

The short duration of the training could not yield in the immediate employment impact as depicted in the chart below:

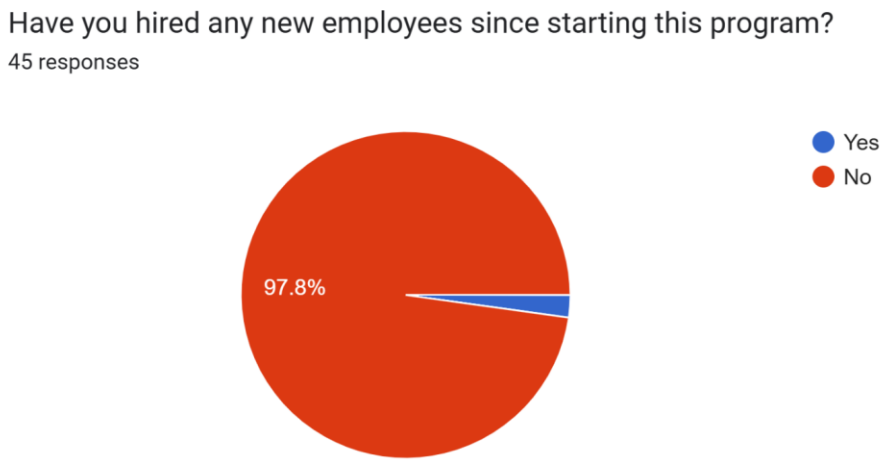


Figure 11 - Employment Impact

5.5 Satisfaction

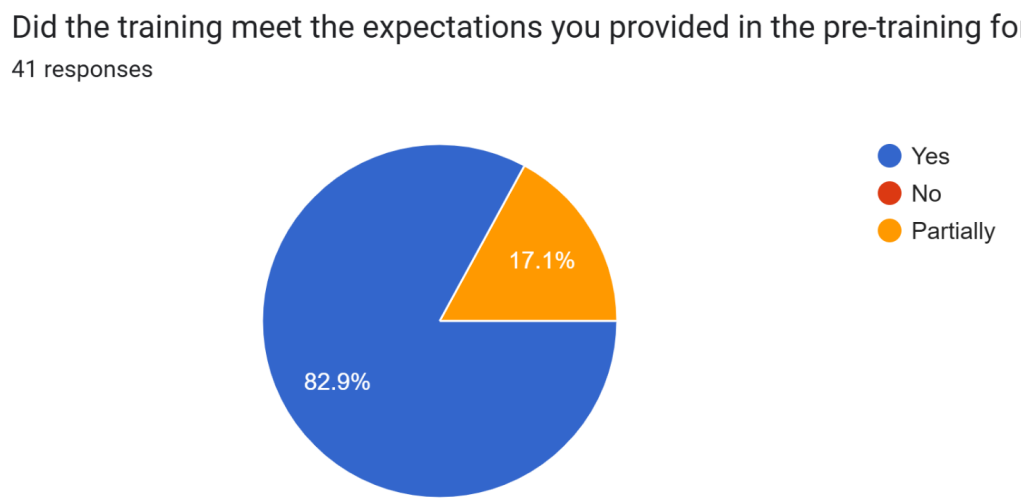


Figure 12 - Expectation Analytics

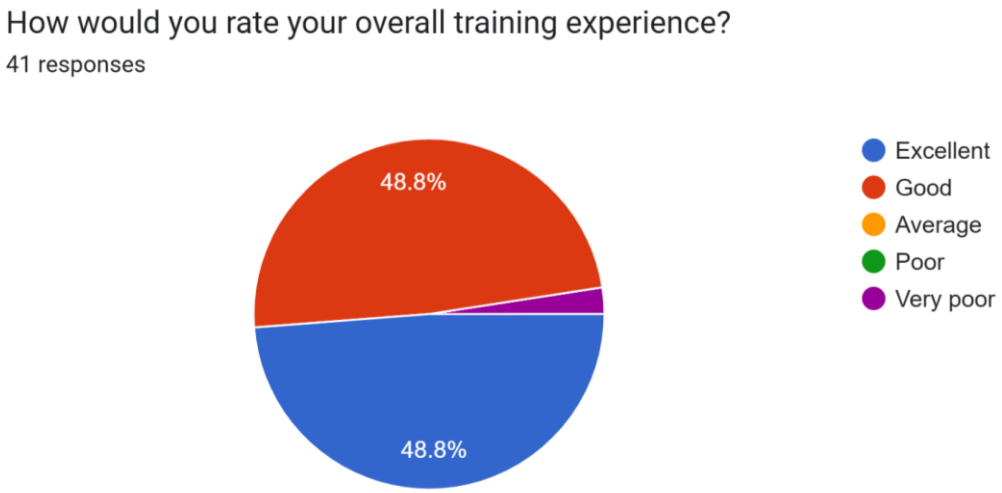


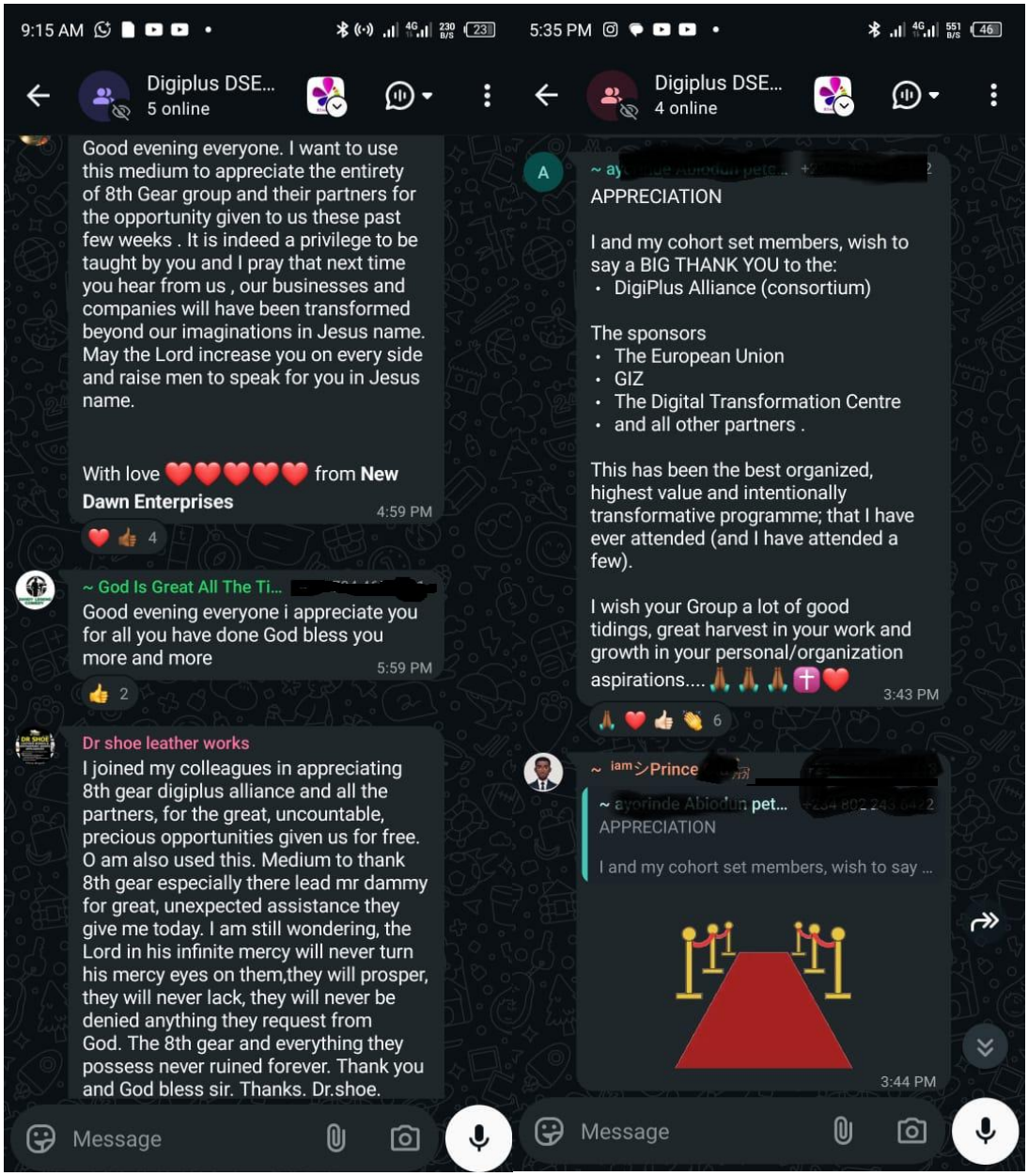
Figure 13 - Overall Training Experience

Figure 14 - Participants' Recommendation Rate

95% rated training Excellent or Good
76% strongly agree to facilitators' demonstrated strong expertise
90%+ expressed satisfaction with physical venues and organization

5.6 Participant Testimonials

Below are screenshots of participants' testimonials from Ogun and Lagos taken from the dedicated WhatsApp group chats and the backend of the post-assessment forms filled.



Follow up and information update on new technology and newsletter should be broadcast to the alumni.

The training was very insightful and practical. It enhanced my understanding of digital tools for small businesses and content creation. More examples of real business life applications would make it even better

Everything is good and fine, we appreciate 8th Gear for their effort in delivering and executing this project, also GIZ... God bless them I pray Amen 🙏

The training should allow for more practical classes,so participants can master the act of using the tools and if possible,there should be follow up classes to help participants with effective running of their business where they need assistance and this can be possible by asking participants for areas where they need assistance.

Te overall training experience was very impactful and excellent. Thank you very much for all the effort and resources put into impact us.

The coordination of the team is highly professional.

Thank you for the opportunity to learn.

Thank you so much for the opportunity. Training well received. I'm Digitally Transformed

Thank you for this great opportunity to be part of Digital entrepreneurship learning DSE program. It is a great experience.
My opinion
1 Some start up didn't have laptop for this training online
2. Data availability is another concern as the online engagement takes a bunch
3. The time frame and schedule isn't enough though the quality of the training s good. I

Thank you once again for the huge opportunity.

6.0 Challenges and Lessons Learnt

6.1 Challenges

- Internet instability affected the consistency of participation for some attendees
- A number of participants did not own personal laptops, limiting their full engagement of the digital tools
- High cost of data usage posed a barrier for sustained online learning
- Condensed schedule constrained the depth of exploration into all digital tools

6.2 Lessons Learnt

- Hybrid learning increases flexibility and participation
- Pre-training digital orientation would reduce learning gaps
- Providing recordings improves catch-up and retention
- Practical, Nigeria-specific case studies help with understanding
- Data support significantly boosts online participation

7.0 Next Steps

8thGear commits to providing accountability and Mentorship support via monthly office hours for the next three months to the top three and four DTRs in Digiplus DSE Cohort 1in Ogun and Lagos respectively.

Ogun	**Lagos**
MeniPraise Supermart	3pple i. Caroline Integrated
Mandyz&Wandyz Apparel	Gidi Chops & Drinks
White & Gold Catering Services LTD	Adaptec Global Engineering Services LTD.

The chart below summarizes the key business barriers that participants reported still facing after completing the DSE training. The findings highlight the structural and operational challenges that continue to limit SMEs' digital transformation progress. "Lack of funding" remains the most significant constraint, followed by limited market reach and high competition within their sectors. Other challenges such as regulatory/legal issues, inadequate marketing strategies, and poor financial management also persist. These insights provide an important context for understanding the ongoing needs of MSMEs and identifying areas for future support.

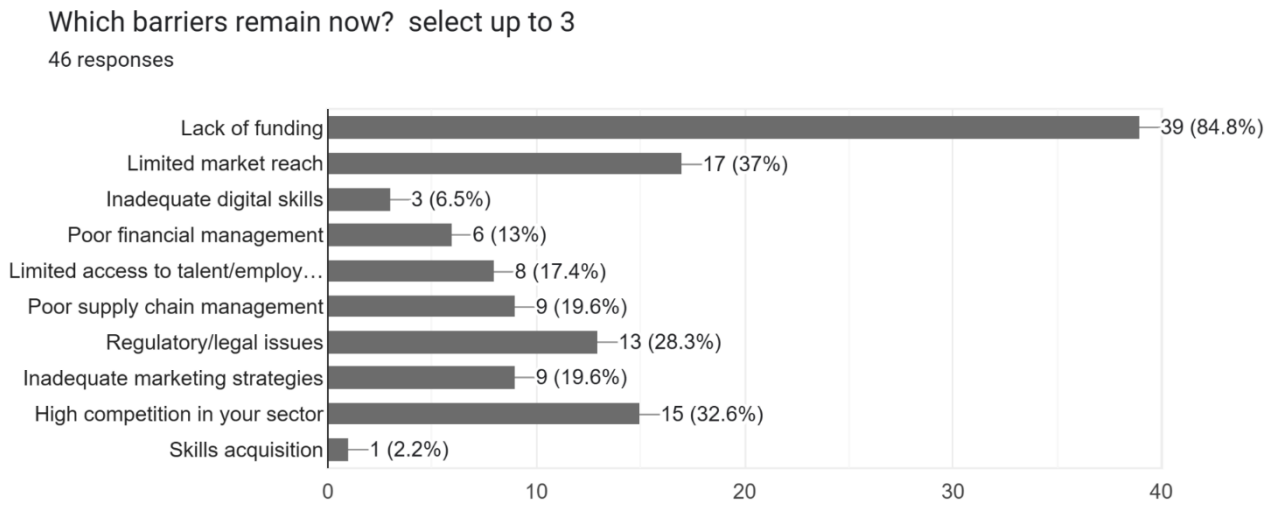


Figure 15 - Reported Business Barriers after DSE training

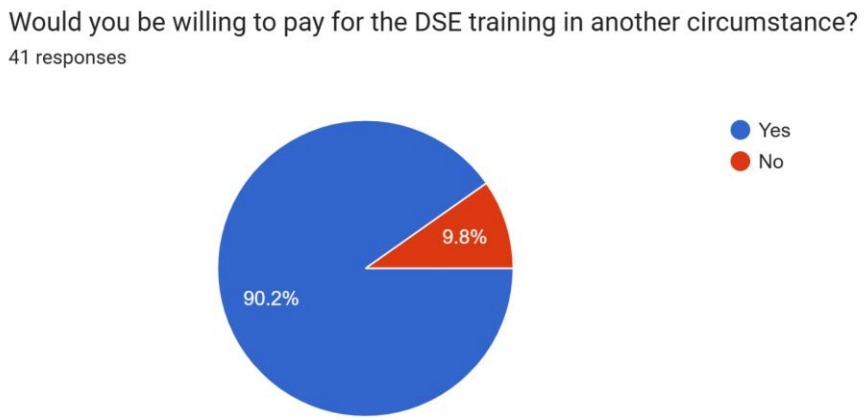


Figure 16 - Participants' Intent for Future DSE Sessions (a)

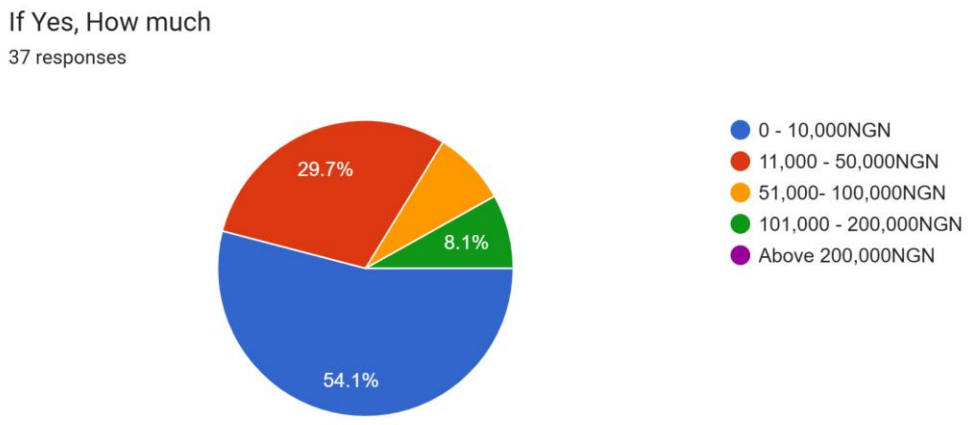


Figure 17 - Participants' Intent for Future DSE Sessions (b)

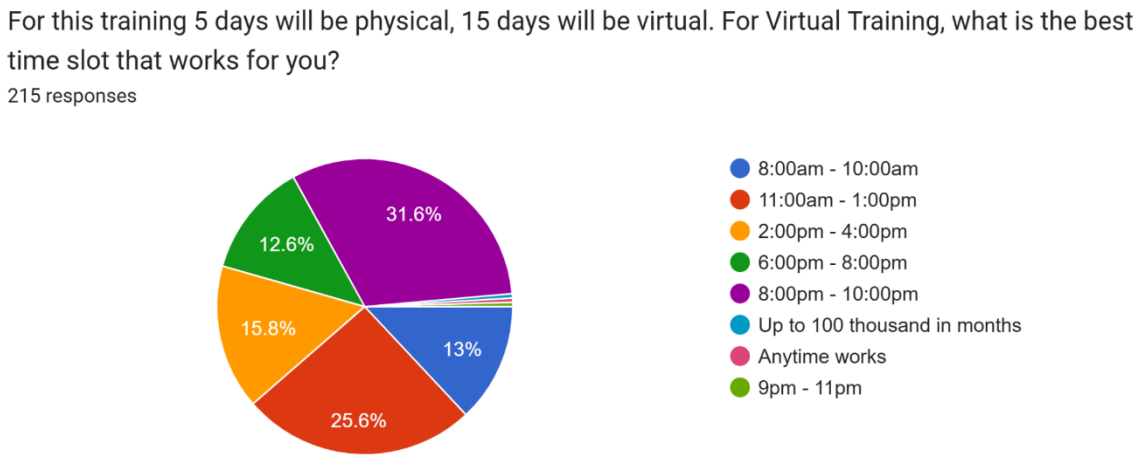


Figure 18 - Participants' Intent for Future DSE Sessions (c)

Applicant Data (Raw Data with some duplicate applications) suggests that MSMEs prefer to take virtual sessions at night after office/business hours.

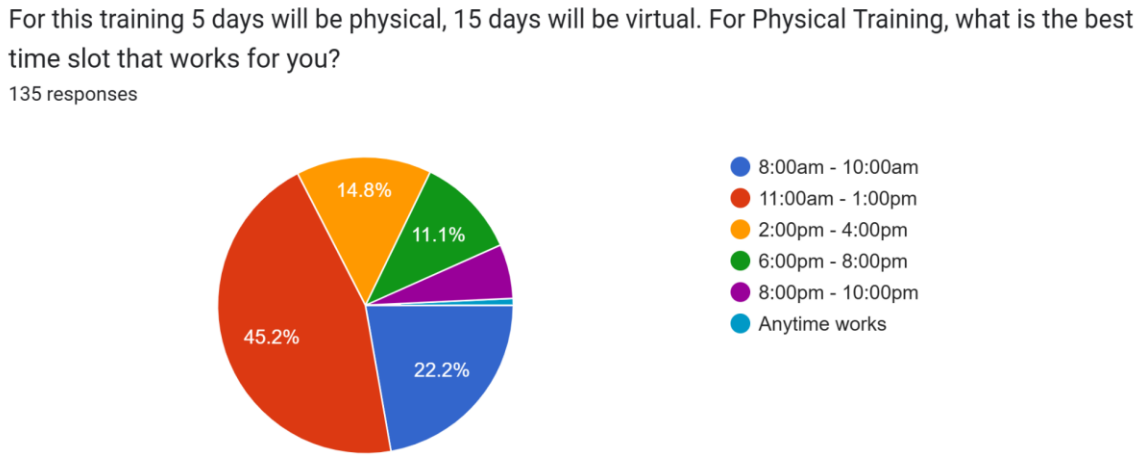


Figure 19 - Participants' Intent for Future DSE Sessions (d)

Applicant Data (Raw Data with some duplicate applications) suggests that MSMEs prefer to take physical sessions at 11:00 am, alternatively, much earlier - before business/office hours.

8.0 Conclusions

The DSE Program executed by Digiplus Alliance effectively enhanced the digital capacity of MSMEs across Ogun and Lagos states. Leveraging a blended learning model, participants acquired practical digital skills that significantly improved their marketing strategies, financial management, operational productivity, and online visibility.

High satisfaction ratings and reported business improvement underscore the program's success and its alignment with DTC Nigeria's mission. To sustain and deepen the impact, continued follow-up support, advanced digital training modules, and more hands-on sessions are recommended.

Annexure

Attendance Sheets (Ogun & Lagos)
Photo Documentation